Anyone can develop a Flutter application easily using the Visual Studio Code editor. However, Android developers prefer Android Studio, because it provides the benefit of using an Android simulator for debugging purposes. Xcode in MacOS enables the power to debug apps on the iOS emulator. Another option is to run the app in real mobile phones by enabling developer options and connecting the mobile to your system, using a USB cable.

Installing Flutter

1. Check the system requirements from the Flutter installation document page at *https://flutter.dev/docs/get-started/install*. For developers using Mac, the specifications are as follows:
   - OS: MacOS (64-bit)
   - Disk space: 2.8GB
   - Command line tools: *bash*, *curl*, *git 2.x*, *mkdir*, *rm*, *unzip*, etc.
2. Download the latest compressed stable Flutter bundle and extract the folder in the desired location on the local system. The current stable version for MacOS while writing this article is *flutter_macos_1.22.4-stable.zip.*
3. Update the path of the Flutter tool temporarily for the current session by using the terminal command, or permanently by editing the *.bash_profile* or *.bashrc* if using *bash* or *.zshrc* if using Z shell. The command to set the path is:

```
$ export PATH="$PATH:[PATH_TO_YOUR_FLUTTER_DIRECTORY]/flutter/bin
```

4. If the path is updated permanently, remember to refresh the current window, or open a new terminal to incorporate the updated changes.
5. Run the command *flutter doctor* to check the setup dependencies.

Creating a Flutter project in Android Studio ID

This article provides steps to create a Flutter project in Android Studio, though developers can opt for Visual Studio Code Editor as well.

1. Initialise Android Studio and click on 'Start a new Flutter Project', as shown in Figure 1.
2. Select the 'Flutter Application' option as shown in Figure 2 to develop a mobile/Web app and click on 'Next'. Developers can also choose to develop a plugin, package or a module for the framework. Packages like *http*, *url_launcher*, *FlutterFire* can be installed from *https://pub.dev/* to reduce the effort in making components from scratch, while modules can also be developed to integrate the existing native Android, iOS or Web app with Flutter.
3. Enter your 'Project Name', add the Flutter SDK path (if not configured while installing the Flutter SDK), select your project location path, and add an app description (optional). Click on the 'Next' button to continue, which is shown in Figure 3.

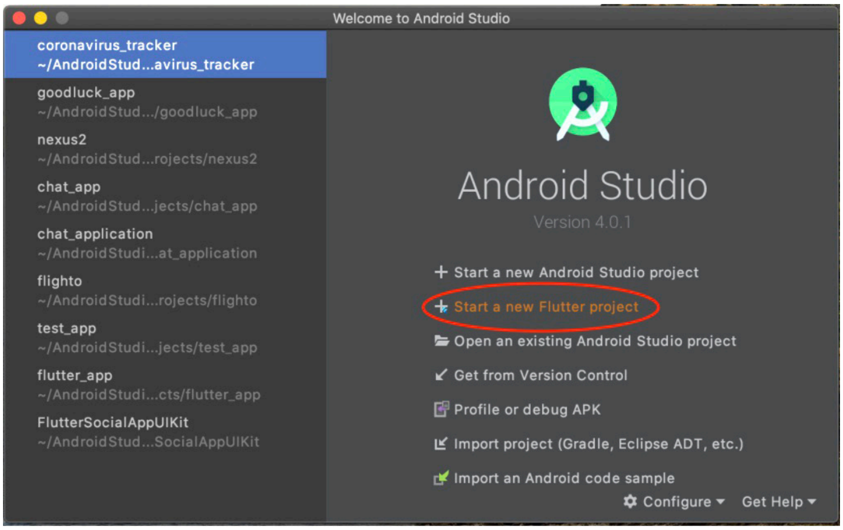

Figure 1: Initialising Android Studio IDE in MacOS

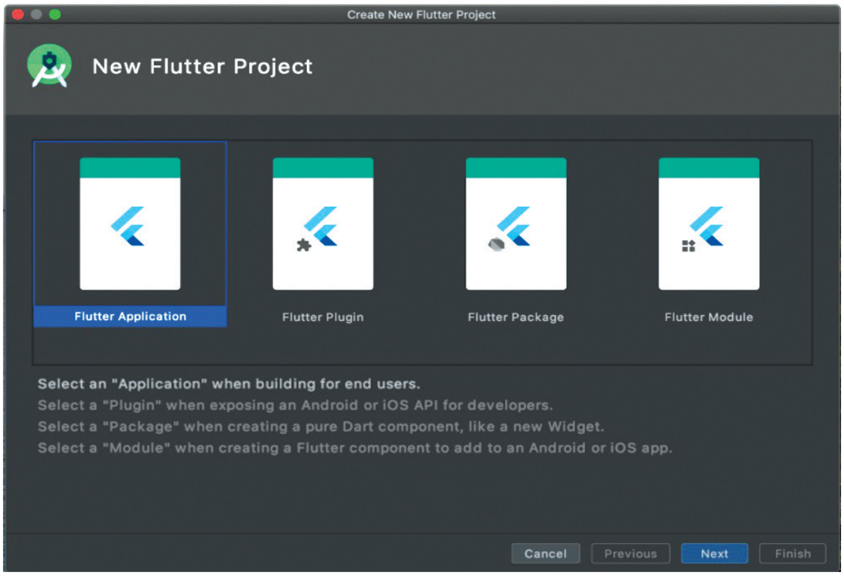

Figure 2: Android Studio: Selecting the Flutter application option